



NEW STARTER BRIEFING

Getting up to speed on Nexus

A synthesis of discovery sessions, video walkthroughs, the Mural discovery board, Figma experience maps, and team meeting transcripts — compiled to give you a fast start.

PLATFORM CONTEXT

AS-IS JOURNEYS

RESELLER HIERARCHY

SYSTEM MAP

OPEN QUESTIONS

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Sources

Mural discovery board · Video walkthroughs

Figma experience map · Team transcripts

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A NOTE ON SOURCES

This document draws on: Nigel Walton (BZ order journey, 26 May), Paul Enright (in-life journey 11 June, reseller hierarchy 8 June), Vijitha M (Hub user management, 24 June), Mohammed Zubairulla (customer establishment, 26 June), Zoya Azar (Mural walkthroughs, 11 & 13 July), Neil Ballinger's Figma experience map, and the Wholesale Portal Scoping Calls (1 & 8 July). The PRD is the authoritative source of truth — these notes may lag behind any recent updates.

SECTION 1

What is Nexus?

Nexus is BT Wholesale's new unified digital portal and API-first platform for resellers. It replaces the current fragmented setup — Business Zone, Business Portal (VEL), and The Hub — with a single strategic portal.

+33
Target NPS (from +12 today)

90%
Strategic product adoption in 24 months

40%
Faster time-to-market

20%
Cost-to-serve reduction

WHAT PROBLEM DOES IT SOLVE?

BT Wholesale resellers currently navigate across multiple disconnected systems to place orders, manage services, configure products, and handle billing. Business Zone handles orders and inventory. Business Portal (VEL) handles product configuration. The Hub handles marketing, learning, and broadband. These are separate systems with separate logins and no unified view.

Nexus brings these together into a single portal built API-first, starting with Digital Voice for Business (DV4B) as the first strategic product migration.

PRODUCTS IN SCOPE — PHASED

PRODUCT	LEGACY NAME	STRATEGIC DESTINATION	PHASE
WHC / WHC Express	Wholesale Hosted Communications (= Cloud Voice)	DV4B — Digital Voice for Business	Priority 1
DIA, Ethernet	DIA, Ethernet	UK Fabric (under evaluation)	Evaluating
L3 BB / L2 BB	BB1 / WBMC	Strategic BB (stays in Hub for now)	Later
PDPL	Pre-Digital Phone Line (= PSTN)	Retained as-is	Later

DV4B — KEY CONSTRAINT
DV4B is **Centrex only**. No SIPT (physical on-prem equipment), no mixed sites. This is a narrower scope than WHC which supported both. The DV4B parity exercise — establishing feature-for-feature equivalence with WHC — is the current delivery focus.

SECTION 2

The current digital estate

Three systems make up the as-is reseller-facing estate. Understanding how they connect — and who can access what — is foundational to everything else on the project.

Business Zone (BZ)

The primary reseller portal. Handles: placing orders, viewing order status, inventory and reports, repairs and faults, billing. Purple/indigo UI. This is where the WHC ordering journey lives.

Business Portal (VEL)

The underlying network management platform. Used for product configuration — features, calling rules, phone services, schedules. Resellers cannot log in directly: access is only via SSO from Business Zone. Direct access was removed ~2 years ago.

The Hub (Partner Plus)

The Nexus-era reseller portal. Purple BT brand UI. Sections: Dashboard, Sales & marketing, Product, Learning, Ordering (new + existing), Billing, Invoices. Broadband products currently live here — no plans to move these in Phase 1.

SAF (Sign-in / Auth)

Authentication layer. Email or username → Password flow. Shared login infrastructure underpinning the portal. One of the core services the Strategic Portal reuses from the existing Hub.

HOW THEY CONNECT

The most important system relationship to understand is **BZ → VEL via SSO**:

1. Reseller logs into Business Zone
2. Goes to Inventory & Reports → Inventory tab
3. Clicks on a service (e.g. WHC) → Quick view opens
4. Selects "Configure on BP" → SSO passes them into VEL for that specific customer
5. The scope of data visible in VEL is determined by which **CUG (Closed User Group)** was selected in BZ

VEL REDESIGN IS OUT OF SCOPE FOR NEXUS

A separate team owns the full VEL redesign. The Nexus team's job is only to **enable SSO access to VEL from the new Strategic Portal**. VEL's UI and information architecture are not being touched in this programme.

WHAT NEXUS REPLACES — AND WHAT IT KEEPS

The Strategic Portal is not a like-for-like replacement of all three systems. Key decisions confirmed as of July 2026:

- **Digital voice products (DV4B)** — live in the new Strategic Portal from Phase 1

- **Broadband (L2/L3 BB)** — stays in the existing Hub. The new portal just needs a jump link on the dashboard to route resellers there
- **VEL access** — enabled from the new portal via SSO, not rebuilt
- **Core portal services (login, RBAC)** — built once, shared across the Strategic Portal

SECTION 3

Personas & reseller hierarchy

8 personas defined in the PRD. The reseller hierarchy is the most important structural concept to grasp — it shapes everything from access levels to support flows.

PERSONAS (PRD)

RESELLER Reseller Admin Manages accounts, users, and products for their org	RESELLER Reseller User Operates within permissions set by their Reseller Admin	SUB-RESELLER Sub-Reseller Admin Admin within a sub-reseller org, inherits parent constraints
SUB-RESELLER Sub-Reseller User Standard user at sub-reseller level	INTERNAL BT BT Internal Admin Sets access rules, onboards resellers, manages hierarchy	INTERNAL BT BT Account Manager / Support Internal user; account management and support
API API Supplier Third party supplying services or data via API	API API Consumer / Partner Developer Developer consuming BT Wholesale APIs	

RESELLER ORG HIERARCHY

Underlying provider is **OpenReach** (hardware). Above that, BT Wholesale. Below BT Wholesale, four types of reseller org can exist in a parent-child tree:

ORG TYPE	ANALOGY	BT RELATIONSHIP	KEY RESTRICTIONS VS DIRECT RESELLER
Direct Reseller (Super Reseller)	—	BT's direct customer	None — full access. Can open support tickets with BT.
Child Reseller	"Teenager" — more mature	Not BT's customer	Cannot open BT support tickets — must go via parent Super Reseller, who raises on their behalf.
Sub-Reseller	"7–8 year old" — less mature	Not BT's customer	No Business Zone access. No hardware ordering. No support tickets. No FMS/Empirix access.
Dealer	Commission agent	Not BT's customer	Lowest privilege. Can only see Business Portal (VEL). Gets commission from child reseller's sales. Doesn't invoice the end customer directly.

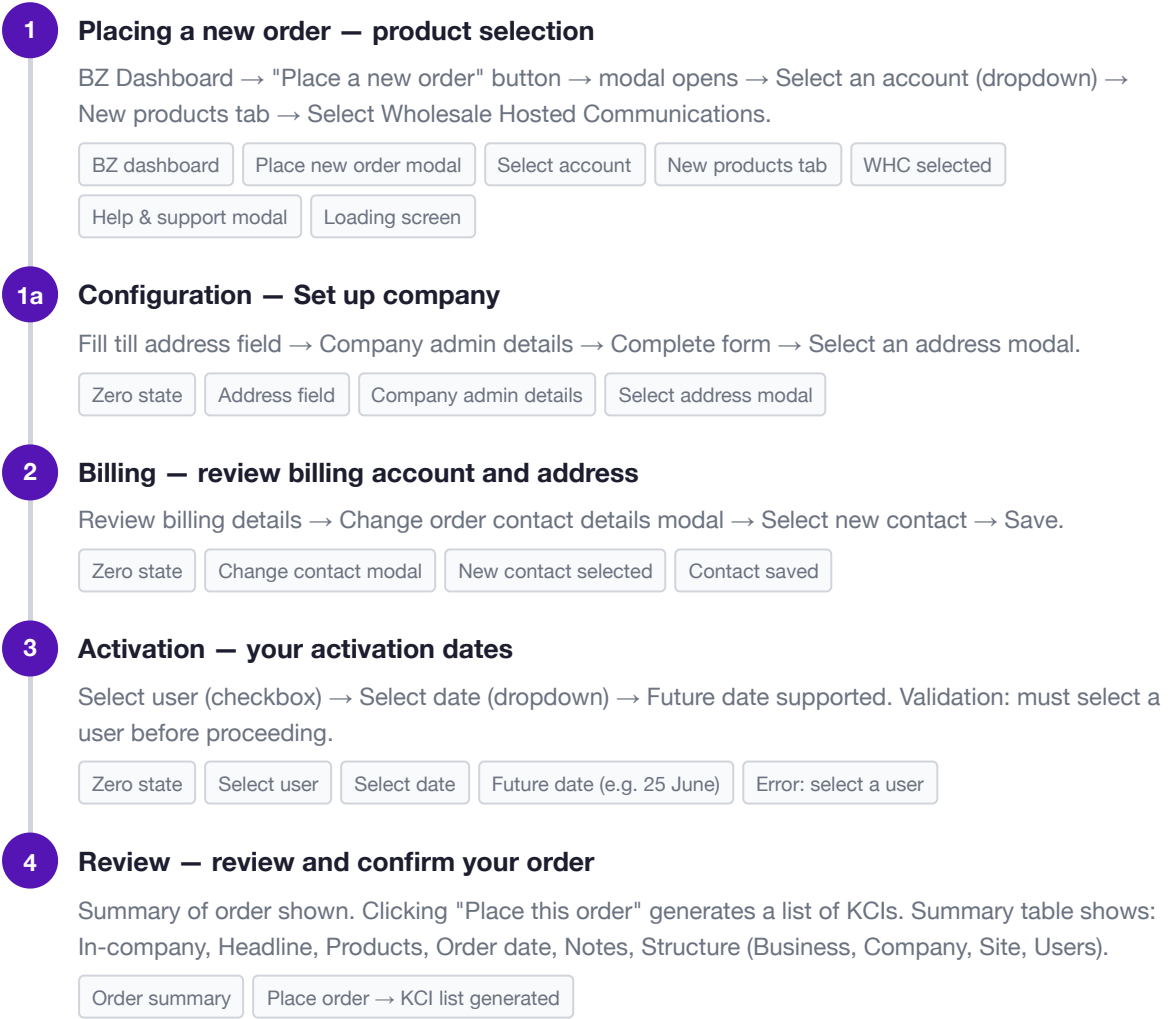
THE CRITICAL COMMERCIAL BOUNDARY

BT Wholesale's commercial relationship extends only to the **Direct/Super Reseller**. Everything below (Child, Sub, Dealer) is the Super Reseller's responsibility. This is why Child Resellers can't open BT support tickets — BT doesn't have a commercial relationship with them. Their Super Reseller is accountable.

SECTION 4

The ordering journey (as-is)

The WHC new order journey in Business Zone. Documented by Nigel Walton (Wholesale Voice Consultant), 26 May 2026. Fully self-served by the reseller — no BT operations involvement. Typically 10–12 minutes for an experienced reseller.



BULK USER UPLOAD

Users can be added in bulk via Excel template upload. Future activation dates are supported. No BT operations staff are involved — fully self-served.

ALSO VISIBLE IN BZ

Most recent orders tab shows order history. The full order journey follows: Company → Numbers → Site → Users → Billing → Activation.

SECTION 5

In-life management (as-is)

Once an order is live, resellers manage it through Business Zone and Business Portal (VEL). Documented by Paul Enright (Wholesale Voice Consultant), 11 June 2026.

MODIFYING AN EXISTING ORDER

Entry point: BZ Dashboard → Inventory & Reports page → Inventory tab → Click on service type → Drill down: site → location → users → "Add another item."

What can be modified?

- **Add a user** → Help & support modal → Configuration screen → Add Centrix user → User details, User license, IP phones, Headset, Accessories, Delivery details → Summary
- **Add CPE additional** (equipment not linked to a specific user) → IP phones, Headsets, Accessories, Delivery details → Summary. Note: in the modify flow, user details and user license steps are absent — you're ordering equipment only, not provisioning a user.
- **Add a site** — option visible but not walked through in sessions

CPE ADDITIONAL UX QUIRK (PAIN POINT)

When selecting IP phones, if you click "Next" without adding the phone to the order, a warning appears: *"You have not added this IP phone to your order. Click cancel and then Add to add it. If you do not want this phone, click Next to remove it."* — confusing interaction that is a known friction point.

CALL RECORDS (CDRS)

- CDRs sent every 15 minutes to an FTP location
- Rated calls every 4 hours
- No in-portal reporting currently exists

BRANDING

Resellers can white-label the Business Portal. The base branding is BT blue. A branded reseller has their logo, colour scheme (e.g. green), and icons applied throughout. Branding comes at a cost to the reseller.

ACCESSING VEL (BUSINESS PORTAL) VIA SSO

This is how resellers get from BZ into VEL to configure a product:

1. BZ → Inventory & Reports → Inventory tab
2. Click on a service (e.g. WHC) → Quick view opens

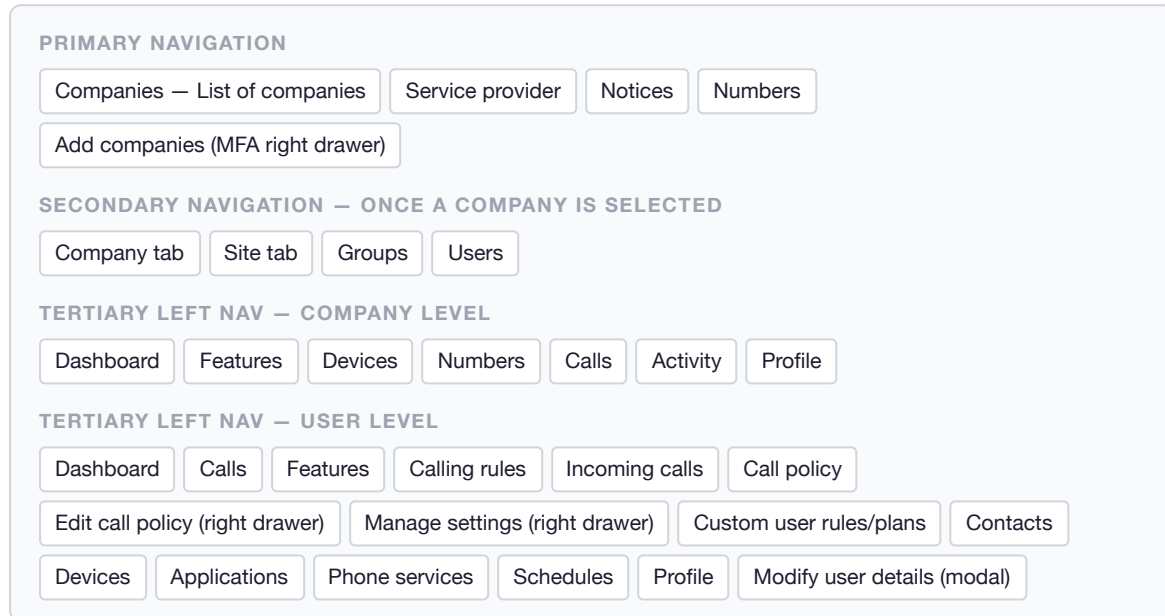
3. Select "Configure on BP" → **CUG selection modal appears** (ability to change CUG — noted as a friction point)
4. SSO passes reseller into VEL for that specific customer

The CUG (Closed User Group) selected in BZ determines the scope of data visible once in VEL. Resellers have no way to access VEL directly — this SSO path is the only route in.

SECTION 6

Business Portal (VEL) — navigation structure

Once inside VEL via SSO, the navigation has three tiers. Everything looks the same at every level — there are no visual markers to tell you whether you're at company, site, or user level. This is a known UX problem (Zoya's observation).



NAVIGATION CONFUSION — KNOWN PAIN POINT

"Everything looks the same. It's so tough to tell — am I at company level, site level, user level?" (Zoya Azar, 13 July 2026). Dashboard and Company share the same view. The left navigation changes per level but there are no clear orientation cues. This is **not being fixed in Nexus Phase 1** — a separate team owns VEL redesign.

WHAT VEL IS USED FOR

VEL is the **configuration layer** for any hosted communications service. Business Zone and the Hub handle purchasing and order placement. VEL handles everything post-order: feature configuration, calling rules, device assignment, number management, user profile management.

End customers can also access VEL directly (unlike resellers, who must go via BZ SSO).

NUMBERS SECTION

- Numbers tab — in-page view of all numbers
- Number ranges tab — in-page view of number range allocations
- Notices — notification area

SECTION 7

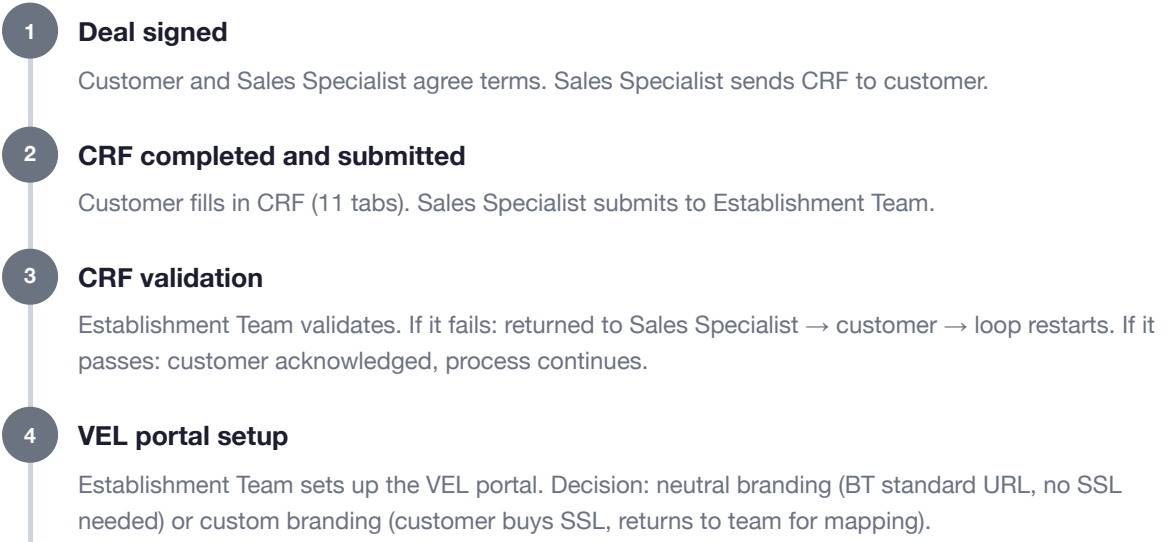
WHC onboarding — the CRF process

This is the as-is process for onboarding a new WHC customer. It involves 11 spreadsheet tabs, 23+ systems, and 12 working day SLA. Walked through by Mohammed Zubairulla (BTW Customer Service Advisor), 26 June 2026, and by Deepa (swim lane diagram). This is primarily Service Designer territory.

STAKEHOLDERS IN THE PROCESS

STAKEHOLDER	ROLE IN PROCESS
Customer	Fills in the CRF (Customer Request Form). Provides company, site, user, and billing data.
Sales Specialist	Makes the commercial deal with the customer. Sends CRF to customer; submits completed CRF to Establishment Team.
Establishment Team	Mohammed's team. Validates the CRF, sets up the VEL portal (neutral or branded), raises SMB requests, coordinates training.
SMVP Assurance Team	Receives SMB request from Establishment Team. Creates the VEL account. Sends completion confirmation.
Training Team (ITEL)	Schedules and delivers offline training to the customer POC. Marks training completion.
Billing Team / One C Bill	Handles billing setup as part of the process.
BT Wholesale Support	Support coverage during onboarding period.

HIGH-LEVEL PROCESS FLOW



5

Account creation + call recording

Customer account created in the Toolring portal. Call recording portal access set up. SMB request raised to SMVP Assurance Team.

6

Training

SMVP creates account, sends completion. Establishment Team raises training request to ITEL. ITEL schedules offline training, delivers to customer POC, marks completion.

7

Customer goes live

Customer onboarded and begins using the service. 12 working day SLA from CRF submission to go-live.

SCOPE NOTE FOR NEXUS

As of July 2026, the team is leaning towards keeping customer establishment out of the Strategic Portal scope — it's a complex ecosystem in its own right. Deepa's swim lane diagram (available on Mural) is the best detailed reference if you need to go deeper on this process.

SECTION 8

Migration to the Strategic Portal

Shared by John on the Wholesale Portal Scoping Call (1 July 2026). Shows which legacy products migrate to the Strategic Portal, the phasing, and the rationale. Blue = legacy products. Purple = strategic products.

LEGACY (BUSINESS ZONE)	STRATEGIC PORTAL DESTINATION	PRIORITY	NOTES
WHC	DV4B (Digital Voice for Business)	Priority 1	Same term on wholesale and business sides. Order journey paused pending stakeholder input on DV4B structure.
WHC Express	DV4B	Priority 1	Centrex-only. No SIPT or mixed sites.
DIA, Ethernet	UK Fabric (React?)	Evaluating	Team evaluating whether to build DIA/Ethernet journeys on the portal from legacy APIs as a stepping stone to UK Fabric.
L3 BB (BB1) — Fully managed, BT manages IP	1Gb+ (BB1) → Strategic BB	Later	Already on Hub — no blocker. Not touching this experience in Phase 1. Needs a jump link from new portal dashboard only.
L2 BB (WBMC) — Backdoor broadband product	Strategic BB	Later	Same as above.
PDPL (Pre-Digital Phone Line)	PDPL (retained)	Later	Called PSTN on the business side. No change planned in Phase 1.

CORE PORTAL SERVICES (SHARED FOUNDATION)

Building on the existing Wholesale Hub lets the team reuse two critical services without rebuilding them:

- **User registration** — existing login and account setup infrastructure
- **RBAC (Role-Based Access Control)** — the permission model that determines what each reseller tier and user role can see and do. This is the primary design focus for Phase 1.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR SERVICE DESIGN

The migration is not a rebuild — it's a progressive consolidation. Services move to the Strategic Portal as they reach readiness. The as-is journeys (BZ, VEL, Hub) continue to operate in parallel during migration. Your as-is mapping work directly informs what gets simplified, carried over, or retired.

SECTION 9

Team, sources & open questions

Key people you'll be working with and the recorded sessions available to review.

DESIGN TEAM

PERSON	ROLE	CURRENT FOCUS
Neil Ballinger	Design Lead (line manager)	Experience Map, programme direction
Johnny Huntington	Product Designer	RBAC — user journey flows per reseller tier
Zoya Azar	Product Designer	Login screens, Dashboard, RBAC wireframes
Deepa	Service Designer	As-is journey mapping (WHC), CRF swim lane diagram
Jason Grant	Service Designer	TBD — you!

KEY SMES YOU'LL ENCOUNTER

PERSON	ROLE	SESSIONS
Nigel Walton	Wholesale Voice Consultant	BZ Order Journey (26 May)
Paul Enright	Wholesale Voice Consultant	Reseller Hierarchy (8 June), In-Life & CPE (11 June)
Mohammed Zubairulla	BTW Customer Service Advisor	Customer Establishment (26 June)
Vijitha M	QA Engineering Specialist	Hub User Management (24 June)

DISCOVERY MURAL — SESSION LOG

Zoya has built a discovery Mural board with screenshots and notes from every session. All session recordings are linked in the Mural. Ask Zoya for access.

DATE	SESSION	PRESENTER
26 May	Business Zone — Order Journey	Nigel Walton
8 Jun	Intro and Reseller Hierarchy	Paul Enright
10 Jun	Reporting (WIP)	—
11 Jun	In-Life and CPE Journey	Paul Enright
18 Jun	Billing (WIP)	—
23 Jun	WHC Walkthrough — Misc	—

DATE	SESSION	PRESENTER
24 Jun	Hub — Manage User Walkthrough	Vijitha M
26 Jun	Customer Establishment in Hub (WIP)	Mohammed Zubairulla
1 Jul	Wholesale Portal Scoping — Call 1	Cross-functional team
6 Jul	Current Journey — L1	—
8 Jul	Wholesale Portal Scoping — Call 2	—

OPEN QUESTIONS — THINGS STILL UNKNOWN

- RL2C access for Direct and Child Resellers — marked "?" in Paul's capability table
- Group CLI access for Direct and Child Resellers — also "?"
- Whether Customer Establishment will be in scope for the Strategic Portal
- DV4B structure — team awaiting stakeholder input before resuming the order journey design
- SSO / Identity stream — unowned in the delivery plan
- Reporting and Billing sessions detail — sticky note content not yet fully captured

BEST STARTING POINT

Watch the Paul Enright recordings (8 June reseller hierarchy, 11 June in-life journey) — they give the clearest picture of how the current system works and who uses it. Then look at Deepa's CRF swim lane diagram for the onboarding process detail. Ask Zoya for access to the full Mural board.